MODALES DE DEDUCCIÓN

Nivel B2

Modals of deduction · must, might, can't

Usamos MUST, MIGHT, COULD, CAN'T para deducir: decir lo seguros que estamos de algo, ahora o en el pasado.

1 Termómetro de certeza

must	seguro que sí (95%)
may / might / could	quizás (50%)
can't	seguro que no (95%)

2 Presente

- modal + infinitivo (sin to)
- She must be at home. (Debe de estar en casa.)
- He can't be 40! (¡No puede tener 40!)

3 Pasado

- modal + have + participio
- They must have left. (Se habrán ido.)
- She might have missed the bus.

4 En este momento

- modal + be + -ing
- He must be working. (Estará trabajando.)
- They might be sleeping.

5 Negativas

- Imposible → can't / couldn't
- Quizás no → might not / may not
- ~~mustn't~~ NO sirve para deducir.

7 Error común

✗ He mustn't be at home.

✓ He can't be at home.

Seguro que no → can't, nunca ~~mustn't~~

6 Consejo rápido

- Pista → conclusión: The lights are off. → They must be out.
- could = might, pero couldn't = can't.

Mini ejercicio

Completa con must, might o can't.
Complete with must, might or can't.

1. Her lights are on. She _____ be in.
2. He's only 15. He _____ be a doctor!
3. Take an umbrella. It _____ rain.
4. The road is wet. It _____ have rained.
5. I _____ have left my keys at work. Not sure.

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📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel B2

Explicación · Explanation

Lee cada recuadro despacio. Primero en español, luego en inglés. Read each box slowly: first in Spanish, then in English.

¿Qué es? · What is it?

Los **modales de deducción** sirven para **sacar conclusiones** a partir de pistas, como un detective. No hablan de obligación ni de habilidad, sino de **lo seguros que estamos**. En español usamos deber de, seguro que, a lo mejor, puede que, no puede ser que o el **futuro de probabilidad** (Estará en casa · Serán las tres). En inglés lo normal es usar un **modal**.

Modals of deduction help us to **draw conclusions** from evidence. They show how sure we are that something is true, now or in the past.

Presente: sujeto + must / might / can't + infinitivo

Pasado: sujeto + must / might / can't + have + participio

El termómetro de la certeza · How sure are you?

Modal	Certeza · Certainty	En español
must	✅ 95 % sí	debe de, seguro que, tiene que
may	🤔 50 %	puede que
might / could	🤔 40-50 %	a lo mejor, quizás, podría
may not / might not	🤷 50 % no	puede que no
can't / couldn't	❌ 95 % no	no puede ser que, es imposible

Si estás **100 % seguro**, no uses modal: She is at home (lo sé). El modal es para **deducir**.

If you are 100% sure, don't use a modal.

1 · MUST: seguro que sí · MUST: I'm sure it's true

Usamos **must** cuando tenemos una **pista fuerte** y estamos casi seguros de que algo **es verdad**. Equivale a debe de / seguro que / tiene que o al futuro de probabilidad (estará). ¡Ojo! Aquí **must** no es obligación.

We use **must** when we have strong evidence and we're almost sure something **is true**. Here, must is not an obligation.

sujeto + must + infinitivo (be, know, have…)

🤒 You've been travelling all day. You **must be** exhausted.
→ Llevas todo el día viajando. Debes de estar agotado.

🍽️ There's a queue round the block. That restaurant **must be** good.
→ Hay cola hasta la esquina. Ese restaurante tiene que ser bueno.

📵 Ana isn't answering. She **must be** in a meeting.
→ Ana no contesta. Estará en una reunión.

Truco del detective · The detective trick

Piensa como Sherlock: **pista → conclusión**. Y si en español usarías el **futuro o el condicional de probabilidad** (estará, habrá ido, serían las diez), en inglés usa **must / might / can't**: Estará en casa → She must be at home. Habrá perdido el tren → He must have missed the train.

Think like Sherlock: evidence → conclusion. Spanish 'estará / habrá ido' = must be / must have gone.

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2 · MAY, MIGHT, COULD: quizás · MAY, MIGHT, COULD: perhaps

Para algo **posible** pero no seguro. **may**, **might** y **could** significan casi lo mismo: puede que, a lo mejor, quizás. **might** es el más frecuente al hablar; **may** suena algo más formal. Detrás va el **infinitivo**: en español usamos subjuntivo (puede que esté), en inglés no.

For something **possible** but not certain. May, might and could mean almost the same. After them, use the infinitive.

sujeto + may / might / could + infinitivo

- Don't wait for me. I **might be** late.
  → No me esperes. Puede que llegue tarde.
- Take a jacket. It **could** get cold tonight.
  → Llévate una chaqueta. Podría hacer frío esta noche.
- The flight **may be** delayed because of the storm.
  → Puede que el vuelo se retrase por la tormenta.

3 · CAN'T / COULDN'T: imposible · CAN'T / COULDN'T: impossible

Cuando estamos **seguros de que algo NO es verdad**, usamos **can't** (o **couldn't**). Es el contrario de must. ¡Nunca **mustn't**! **mustn't** es prohibición (no debes), no deducción. En preguntas usamos **can** o **could**: Where can she be? · Could it be true?

When we're sure something is **not** true, we use **can't** or **couldn't**, never mustn't. In questions: Where can she be? Could it be true?

sujeto + can't / couldn't + infinitivo

- That **can't be** Javi. He's on holiday in Peru.
  → Ese no puede ser Javi. Está de vacaciones en Perú.
- You **can't be** hungry! You've just had lunch.
  → ¡No puedes tener hambre! Acabas de comer.
- It **can't be** true. I don't believe it.
  → No puede ser verdad. No me lo creo.

Los negativos: ¡cuidado! · Negatives: be careful!

Forma	Significado	Ejemplo
can't	imposible	He can't be ill. I saw him at the gym.
couldn't	imposible	It couldn't be him. He's abroad.
might not / may not	puede que no	He might not come tonight.
mustn't	¡prohibición! (no deducción)	You mustn't park here.

could = posible · **couldn't** = imposible. Could = possible; couldn't = impossible.

4 · Ahora mismo: modal + be + -ing · Right now: modal + be + -ing

Para deducir lo que alguien está haciendo en este momento: **must / might / can't + be + -ing**. En español: estará + gerundio o puede que esté + gerundio.

To guess what someone is doing right now: must / might / can't + be + -ing.

sujeto + must / might / can't + be + verbo-ing

- Leo isn't picking up. He **must be driving**.
  → Leo no lo coge. Estará conduciendo.
- Shh! The baby **might be sleeping**.
  → ¡Chis! Puede que el bebé esté durmiendo.
- They **can't be working**. It's Sunday!
  → No pueden estar trabajando. ¡Es domingo!

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5 · Deducción en pasado: modal + have + participio · Past deduction: modal + have + past participle

Para sacar conclusiones sobre **algo que ya pasó**: **must have** (seguro que sí), **may / might / could have** (quizás), **can't / couldn't have** (imposible) + **participio**. **have** no cambia nunca (~~has~~) y se pronuncia débil: must've /ˈmʌstəv/.

To make deductions about **the past**: must have / might have / can't have + past participle. **Have** never changes.

sujeto + must / might / can't + have + participio

The streets are wet. It **must have rained** last night.
→ Las calles están mojadas. Debe de haber llovido anoche.

I can't find my wallet. I **might have left** it in the taxi.
→ No encuentro la cartera. Puede que me la haya dejado en el taxi.

She **can't have seen** my message. Her phone was off.
→ No puede haber visto mi mensaje. Tenía el móvil apagado.

MUST: ¿obligación o deducción? · MUST: obligation or deduction?

must tiene dos caras. Si hay una **pista** y sacas una conclusión, es deducción. Pero el contrario de la deducción es **can't**: **mustn't** solo significa prohibición.

If there's evidence and you draw a conclusion, must is deduction. Its opposite is **can't**; mustn't only means prohibition.

📏 Obligación (otro tema)

- You **must** wear a seatbelt. (tienes que)
- You **mustn't** smoke here. (prohibido)

🕵 Deducción (este tema)

- You **must** be Ana's sister! (seguro que eres)
- She **can't** be at work. (es imposible)

Todo junto · All together

Certeza · Certainty	Presente	Ahora mismo (-ing)	Pasado	En español
✅ Seguro que sí	She **must be** tired.	She **must be working**.	She **must have worked** late.	Debe de estar / Estará
🤔 Posible	She **may / might / could be** tired.	She **might be working**.	She **might have worked** late.	Puede que esté
🤷 Posible que no	She **may not / might not be** tired.	She **might not be working**.	She **might not have worked** late.	Puede que no esté
❌ Seguro que no	She **can't / couldn't be** tired.	She **can't be working**.	She **can't / couldn't have worked** late.	No puede estar

Después del modal: **infinitivo sin to**. En pasado: **have + participio** (gone, seen, been, left…).

After the modal: infinitive without to. Past: have + past participle.

MODALES DE DEDUCCIÓN

Modals of deduction · must, might, can't

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Del español al inglés · From Spanish to English

Español	English
Estará en casa. / Debe de estar en casa.	She must be at home.
Habrá perdido el tren.	He must have missed the train.
Serán las tres.	It must be about three o'clock.
Serían las diez cuando llegó.	It must have been about ten when she arrived.
Puede que se le haya olvidado.	She might have forgotten.
Es imposible que lo haya visto.	She can't have seen it.

🇪🇸 El futuro y el condicional de probabilidad (estará, habrá ido, serían) se expresan en inglés sobre todo con **must / might / can't**.

🇬🇧 Spanish 'future of probability' → must / might / can't.

¿Cómo deduzco? · How do I make a deduction?

1. Mira la **pista** (evidencia): ¿qué sabes seguro?
   🇬🇧 Look at the evidence.
2. Decide la **certeza**: casi seguro que sí → **must** · quizás → **may / might / could** · seguro que no → **can't / couldn't**.
   🇬🇧 Decide how sure you are: must / might / can't.
3. ¿Hablas de **ahora**? → modal + infinitivo. ¿De algo **en curso**? → modal + **be + -ing**.
   🇬🇧 Present → modal + infinitive. In progress → modal + be + -ing.
4. ¿Hablas del **pasado**? → modal + **have** + participio (must have gone). Repasa: sin to, sin -s, nunca has.
   🇬🇧 Past → modal + have + past participle. No to, no -s, never has.

Más ejemplos · More examples

- Someone's knocking. It **must be** the delivery driver.
  → Llaman a la puerta. Será el repartidor.
- Carlos **might be** at the gym. He usually goes on Mondays.
  → Puede que Carlos esté en el gimnasio. Suele ir los lunes.
- This **can't be** the right address. It's a car park!
  → Esta no puede ser la dirección. ¡Es un aparcamiento!
- They **must have won** the match. Listen to the fans!
  → Deben de haber ganado el partido. ¡Escucha a la afición!
- He **couldn't have stolen** the money. He was with me all night.
  → No puede haber robado el dinero. Estuvo conmigo toda la noche.
- I **may have made** a mistake in the report.
  → Puede que haya cometido un error en el informe.
- You **must be joking**!
  → ¡No lo dirás en serio!
- She **might not have got** your email. Check the address.
  → Puede que no le haya llegado tu correo. Revisa la dirección.
- The meeting **must have finished**. Everyone's leaving.
  → La reunión debe de haber terminado. Todos se están yendo.
- It **could be** a virus. You should see a doctor.
  → Podría ser un virus. Deberías ir al médico.
- They **can't have gone** far. Their car is still here.
  → No pueden haber ido muy lejos. Su coche sigue aquí.
- The shop **might be** closed on Sundays. Let's check online.
  → Puede que la tienda cierre los domingos. Mirémoslo en internet.

MODALES DE DEDUCCIÓN

Modals of deduction · must, might, can't

📖 **Explicación** · Explanation | **Nivel B2**



¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~He mustn't be at home. The lights are off.~~

✓ He **can't** be at home. The lights are off.

«Seguro que no» = can't. Mustn't es prohibición. / Negative deduction = can't, not mustn't.

✗ ~~She must to be tired.~~

✓ She must **be** tired.

Después de un modal, infinitivo sin to. / No to after a modal.

✗ ~~It might has rained.~~

✓ It might **have** rained.

En pasado siempre **have**, nunca has. / Always have, never has.

✗ ~~They must have went home.~~

✓ They must have **gone** home.

have + **participio** (gone), no pasado (went). / have + past participle, not past simple.

✗ ~~He must be at home yesterday.~~

✓ He must **have been** at home yesterday.

Para el pasado: must have + participio. / Past deduction: must have + participle.

✗ ~~She can't have be ill.~~

✓ She can't have **been** ill.

have + **been** (participio de be). / have + been.

✗ ~~It mights be true.~~

✓ It **might** be true.

Los modales nunca llevan -s. / Modals never take -s.

✗ ~~I'm not sure, but I must have left it at home.~~

✓ I'm not sure, but I **might** have left it at home.

Si no estás seguro → might / may / could, no must. / Not sure → might, not must.

Misterio en la oficina · A mystery at the office

Iván Marta's not at her desk. Where can she be?
Marta no está en su mesa. ¿Dónde estará?

Sofía She might be in the meeting room. There's a client meeting at ten.
Puede que esté en la sala de reuniones. Hay una reunión con un cliente a las diez.

Iván No, it can't be that. The meeting was cancelled.
No, no puede ser eso. Se canceló la reunión.

Sofía Her coat isn't here, so she must have gone out.
Su abrigo no está, así que habrá salido.

Iván Look, her coffee's still warm. She can't have gone far.
Mira, su café sigue caliente. No puede haber ido muy lejos.

Sofía She could have gone to the bakery. She sometimes buys croissants for everyone.
Puede que haya ido a la panadería. A veces compra cruasanes para todos.

Iván Here she comes… with a big box. You must be a mind reader!
Aquí viene… con una caja grande. ¡Debes de leer la mente!

Ejercicios · Practice

Escribe con lápiz y letra clara. Antes de escribir, piensa qué regla toca. Write in pencil. Think about the rule first.

Name · Nombre _____ Date · Fecha _____ Score _____

Ejercicio 1 ¿Seguro o imposible? · Sure or impossible?

Lee la pista y rodea el modal correcto.
Read the clue and circle the correct modal.

1. Her car's outside. She must / can't be at home.
2. He must / can't be hungry. He's just eaten a huge pizza.
3. I'm not sure where Ana is. She might / must be at the library.
4. You've been working for ten hours. You must / might not be exhausted.
5. That can't / mustn't be the right answer. It doesn't make sense.
6. Take your phone. I might / must need to call you.
7. They've lived in Paris for twenty years. They must / can't speak French.
8. Everyone's talking about the film. It could / can't be good.
9. That can't / might be Mario's dad. He's far too young!
10. It's 3 a.m. in Madrid, so in New York it must / can't be 9 p.m.

Ejercicio 2 Pista y conclusión · Clue and conclusion

Une cada pista con la deducción más lógica.
Match each clue with the most logical deduction.

1 The lights are off and nobody's answering.	a It might be the bank.
2 He's wearing a wedding ring.	b I might have left them at work.
3 She's only been learning Greek for a week.	c She can't be fluent yet.
4 I'm not sure who's calling.	d They must be out.
5 The ground is completely dry.	e She must have had some good news.
6 Pablo got 100% in the exam.	f It can't have rained.
7 My keys aren't in my bag.	g He must have studied hard.
8 Laura's smiling from ear to ear.	h He must be married.

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Ejercicios · Practice | Nivel B2

Ejercicio 3 ¿Cuánta certeza? · How sure?

Clasifica cada expresión según la certeza.
Sort the expressions by how sure the speaker is.

Word bank: must be working · can't be · may have gone · might not be · must have been · can't have seen · must have left · can't be working · must be · might be · couldn't have done · could be

✅ Seguro que sí	🤔 Posible	❌ Imposible

Ejercicio 4 must, might o can't · must, might or can't

Completa con must, might o can't. Piensa en lo seguro que estás.
Complete with must, might or can't.

Word bank: must · might · can't

1. You've done so well! Your parents _____ be really proud of you.
2. Where's Tom? — I'm not sure. He _____ be in the garden.
3. That _____ be Laura's car. She sold it last year.
4. You _____ be serious! A coffee for 12 euros?
5. Don't call now. They _____ be having dinner.
6. He's been running for an hour. He _____ be thirsty.
7. This bag _____ be mine. Mine is black, not blue.

Ejercicio 4 must, might o can't · must, might or can't (continúa · cont.)

8. I _____ go to the party. It depends on how I feel.
9. Everyone is wearing coats. It _____ be cold outside.
10. Ask Elena. She _____ know the answer, but I'm not sure.

Ejercicio 5 Deducción en pasado · Past deduction

Completa con modal + have + participio. Usa las palabras entre paréntesis.
Complete with modal + have + past participle.

1. The window is broken. Someone _____ (must / break) it.
2. She _____ (can't / see) us. She didn't say hello.
3. I _____ (might / leave) my glasses in the car.
4. They _____ (must / be) very happy when they heard the news.
5. He _____ (can't / write) this essay alone. It's full of words he doesn't know.
6. Sara isn't here yet. She _____ (may / miss) the train.
7. You _____ (must / spend) a fortune on that jacket!
8. The thief _____ (could / get) in through the back door.
9. Mark _____ (can't / forget) your birthday. He wrote it in his diary.
10. We _____ (might / take) the wrong turning. Let's check the map.

Ejercicio 6 — Del presente al pasado · From present to past

✍️ Completa la tabla: pasa cada deducción de presente a pasado o al revés.
🇬🇧 Complete the table: change each deduction from present to past or vice versa.

Certeza	Presente · Present	Pasado · Past
✅	He must be at work.	_____
🤔	_____	She might have been ill.
❌	They can't be lost.	_____
✅	_____	You must have known him.
🤔	It could be a mistake.	_____
❌	_____	She can't have been asleep.
🤷	He may not be at home.	_____
✅	_____	They must have been working.

Ejercicio 7 — De la pista al modal · Rewrite with a modal

✍️ Reescribe la frase con must, might / may / could o can't.
🇬🇧 Rewrite the sentence with a modal of deduction.

1. I'm sure she's at home.

2. Perhaps he's busy.

3. It's impossible that this is your bag.

Ejercicio 7 — De la pista al modal · Rewrite with a modal (continúa · cont.)

4. I'm sure they left early.

5. Maybe she didn't get my message.

6. It's impossible that he saw the film. It isn't out yet.

Ejercicio 7 — De la pista al modal · Rewrite with a modal

(continúa · cont.)

7 Perhaps they're watching the match.

8 I'm sure you were tired after the trip.

Ejercicio 8 — ¿Presente o pasado? · Present or past?

Rodea la forma correcta. Fíjate en cuándo pasa la acción.
Circle the correct form.

1 Look at his tan. He must be / must have been on holiday.
2 She's not answering. She might sleep / might be sleeping.
3 Nobody's in. They must go / must have gone out.
4 I can't have met / can't meet him before. He's never left Rome and I've never been there.
5 The museum might be / might have been closed tomorrow. It's a bank holiday.
6 He can't be / can't have been at the party last night. He was in hospital.
7 Listen! Someone must be playing / must have played the piano upstairs.
8 You must be / must have been Laura. Nice to meet you!
9 The exam must be / must have been really hard. Everyone failed.
10 I don't know how they got here yesterday. They could have taken / could take a taxi.

Ejercicio 9 — Ordena la frase · Put the words in order

Ordena las palabras y escribe la frase.
Put the words in order and write the sentence.

1 must | she | be | tired | very
2 can't | that | true | be
3 have | they | must | gone | home
4 might | I | left | have | my phone | in the car
5 be | sleeping | he | might
6 can't | have | she | seen | us
7 may | the | be | delayed | train
8 couldn't | he | have | it | done | alone

Ejercicio 10 Caza el error · Find the mistake

✍️ Cada frase tiene UN error. Escríbela bien.
🇬🇧 Each sentence has ONE mistake. Write it correctly.

1 ✗ He mustn't be Italian. He doesn't understand Italian at all.
✓ _____

2 ✗ She must to be at the gym.
✓ _____

3 ✗ They might has missed the bus.
✓ _____

4 ✗ You must have saw the news.
✓ _____

5 ✗ It mights rain later.
✓ _____

6 ✗ He can't have be at work yesterday.
✓ _____

7 ✗ I'm not sure, but she must have forgotten.
✓ _____

8 ✗ He must be at the cinema last night.
✓ _____

Ejercicio 11 ¿Tiene sentido? · Does it make sense?

✍️ Marca T si la frase es correcta y lógica, y F si no lo es.
🇬🇧 Tick T if the sentence is correct and logical, F if not.

1 He's yawning all the time. He must be tired. T F
2 She's never been to Asia, so she must have visited Tokyo. T F
3 It might be sunny tomorrow, but I'm not sure. T F
4 He mustn't be at home. His car isn't here. T F
5 The road is wet. It must have rained. T F
6 I might have left my keys at home. I'm 100% sure. T F
7 They can't have finished already. They started five minutes ago. T F
8 You must be Javier's sister. You look exactly like him! T F

Ejercicio 12 Transformaciones B2 First · Key word transformations

✍️ Completa la segunda frase para que signifique lo mismo que la primera. Usa la palabra en azul SIN cambiarla y escribe entre 2 y 5 palabras.
🇬🇧 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word given. Write 2–5 words.

1. I'm sure Paula is at work now.
   Paula _____ now. (MUST)

2. Perhaps the shop is closed today.
   The shop _____ today. (MIGHT)

3. It's impossible that this is Tom's phone.
   This _____ phone. (CAN'T)

4. I'm sure they forgot about the meeting.
   They _____ about the meeting. (HAVE)

5. Maybe Elena didn't hear the doorbell.
   Elena _____ the doorbell. (MIGHT)

Ejercicio 12 Transformaciones B2 First · Key word transformations (continúa · cont.)

6. It's impossible that you saw Jake yesterday. He's in Canada.
   You _____ Jake yesterday. (CAN'T)

7. Perhaps the burglars came in through the window.
   The burglars _____ in through the window. (COULD)

8. I'm sure the children are sleeping. It's so quiet.
   The children _____. It's so quiet. (BE)

Ejercicio 13 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

✍️ Traduce. ¡Ojo con el futuro de probabilidad del español!
🇬🇧 Translate into English.

1. 🇪🇸 Debes de estar muy cansado.
   🇬🇧

2. 🇪🇸 Puede que llueva esta tarde.
   🇬🇧

3. 🇪🇸 Eso no puede ser verdad.
   🇬🇧

Ejercicio 13 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

(continúa · cont.)

4 Habrán perdido el tren.

5 Puede que (ella) se haya olvidado.

6 No puede haberlo hecho él solo.

7 (Él) estará trabajando ahora.

8 Serían las diez cuando llegamos.

Ejercicio 14 Lee y contesta · Read and answer

Lee el caso del inspector Ruiz. Marca T o F y contesta.
Read the story. Tick T or F and answer the questions.

The mystery of the empty flat

When Inspector Ruiz arrived at flat 4B, the door was open and nobody was inside. The TV was still on and there was a cup of tea on the table. It was still warm, so the owner, Mr Hall, couldn't have left more than ten minutes earlier.

His coat and umbrella were gone, and it was raining heavily, so he must have gone out. 'He might have gone to the shop on the corner,' said the neighbour. 'He often goes there in the evening.' But the inspector shook his head. 'He can't have gone shopping. His wallet is here on the sofa.'

Then Ruiz noticed a train ticket for Edinburgh on the floor. It was for the 8.15 train. 'It's eight o'clock now. He must be on his way to the station,' he said. 'He could still be in a taxi. Let's go!'

1 The inspector thinks Mr Hall left a long time ago. T F

2 The neighbour is sure Mr Hall went to the shop. T F

3 Mr Hall took his wallet with him. T F

4 Why does the inspector think Mr Hall must have gone out?

5 Why can't he have gone shopping?

Ejercicio 14 Lee y contesta · Read and answer (continúa · cont.)

6 Where does the inspector think Mr Hall is now?

7 Copy a deduction about the present from the last paragraph.

8 Rewrite with a modal: 'Perhaps he went to the shop.'

Ejercicio 15 Ahora escribe tú · Your turn

✍️ Haz de detective. Usa must, might, could y can't (+ have).
Be a detective.

1 Tu amigo no contesta al móvil. Escribe 3 posibilidades (might / could / may).

2 Mira algo de tu casa: escribe una deducción con must.

3 Escribe una frase con can't have sobre una noticia increíble.

4 Llegas a casa y la puerta está abierta. ¿Qué ha pasado?

¿Lo he aprendido? · Can I do it?

Marca cada frase cuando la sepas hacer y colorea las estrellas. Tick each line when you can do it and colour the stars.

Lo sé hacer · I can...

- [ ] Uso **must** cuando estoy casi seguro: She must be tired. ☆☆☆
  I use must when I'm almost sure.
- [ ] Uso **may / might / could** para posibilidades. ☆☆☆
  I use may / might / could for possibilities.
- [ ] Uso **can't / couldn't** para lo imposible (¡no ~~mustn't~~!). ☆☆☆
  I use can't for impossible things, never mustn't.
- [ ] Deduzco en pasado con **modal + have + participio**. ☆☆☆
  I can make past deductions with modal + have + participle.
- [ ] Deduzco lo que pasa ahora con **must be + -ing**. ☆☆☆
  I can guess what's happening now: must be + -ing.
- [ ] Traduzco el futuro de probabilidad (estará, habrá ido) con must / might. ☆☆☆
  I can translate Spanish 'estará / habrá ido'.

Mi progreso · My progress

Colorea 1, 2 o 3 estrellas en cada ejercicio. Colour 1, 2 or 3 stars for each exercise.

Ej. 1 ☆☆☆	Ej. 2 ☆☆☆	Ej. 3 ☆☆☆	Ej. 4 ☆☆☆
Ej. 5 ☆☆☆	Ej. 6 ☆☆☆	Ej. 7 ☆☆☆	Ej. 8 ☆☆☆
Ej. 9 ☆☆☆	Ej. 10 ☆☆☆	Ej. 11 ☆☆☆	Ej. 12 ☆☆☆
Ej. 13 ☆☆☆	Ej. 14 ☆☆☆	Ej. 15 ☆☆☆	

Solucionario · Answer key

Para el adulto que corrige (¡o para comprobar después de hacerlo!). For the grown-up who checks, or to check after you finish.

Mapa · Mini ejercicio

1. must · 2. can't · 3. might / may / could · 4. must · 5. might / may / could

Ejercicio 1 · ¿Seguro o imposible?

1. must · 2. can't · 3. might · 4. must · 5. can't · 6. might · 7. must · 8. could · 9. can't · 10. must

Ejercicio 2 · Pista y conclusión

1-d · 2-h · 3-c · 4-a · 5-f · 6-g · 7-b · 8-e

Ejercicio 3 · ¿Cuánta certeza?

✅ **Seguro que sí:** must be, must have left, must be working, must have been
🤔 **Posible:** might be, may have gone, could be, might not be
❌ **Imposible:** can't be, couldn't have done, can't have seen, can't be working

Ejercicio 4 · must, might o can't

1. must · 2. might · 3. can't · 4. can't · 5. might · 6. must · 7. can't · 8. might · 9. must · 10. might

Ejercicio 5 · Deducción en pasado

1. must have broken · 2. can't have seen · 3. might have left · 4. must have been · 5. can't have written · 6. may have missed · 7. must have spent · 8. could have got · 9. can't have forgotten · 10. might have taken

Ejercicio 6 · Del presente al pasado

Certeza	Presente · Present	Pasado · Past
✅	He must be at work.	He must have been at work.
🤔	She might be ill.	She might have been ill.
❌	They can't be lost.	They can't have been lost.
✅	You must know him.	You must have known him.
🤔	It could be a mistake.	It could have been a mistake.
❌	She can't be asleep.	She can't have been asleep.
🤷	He may not be at home.	He may not have been at home.
✅	They must be working.	They must have been working.

Ejercicio 7 · De la pista al modal

1. She must be at home.
2. He might (may / could) be busy.
3. This can't be your bag.
4. They must have left early.
5. She might (may) not have got my message.
6. He can't (couldn't) have seen the film. It isn't out yet.
7. They might (may / could) be watching the match.
8. You must have been tired after the trip.

Ejercicio 8 · ¿Presente o pasado?

1. must have been · 2. might be sleeping · 3. must have gone · 4. can't have met · 5. might be · 6. can't have been · 7. must be playing · 8. must be · 9. must have been · 10. could have taken

MODALES DE DEDUCCIÓN

Modals of deduction · must, might, can't

🔑 Solucionario · Answer key

Nivel B2

Ejercicio 9 · Ordena la frase

1. She must be very tired.
2. That can't be true.
3. They must have gone home.
4. I might have left my phone in the car.
5. He might be sleeping.
6. She can't have seen us.
7. The train may be delayed.
8. He couldn't have done it alone.

Ejercicio 10 · Caza el error

1. He can't be Italian. He doesn't understand Italian at all.
2. She must be at the gym.
3. They might have missed the bus.
4. You must have seen the news.
5. It might rain later.
6. He can't have been at work yesterday.
7. I'm not sure, but she might have forgotten. / I'm not sure, but she may have forgotten.
8. He must have been at the cinema last night.

Ejercicio 11 · ¿Tiene sentido?

1. True ✓
2. False ✗ — She can't have visited Tokyo.
3. True ✓
4. False ✗ — He can't be at home.
5. True ✓
6. False ✗ — 100% seguro → I left my keys at home.
7. True ✓
8. True ✓

Ejercicio 12 · Transformaciones B2 First

1. must be at work · 2. might be closed · 3. can't be Tom's · 4. must have forgotten · 5. might not have heard · 6. can't have seen · 7. could have come · 8. must be sleeping

Ejercicio 13 · Traduce al inglés

1. You must be very tired.
2. It might (may / could) rain this afternoon.
3. That can't be true.
4. They must have missed the train.
5. She might (may / could) have forgotten.
6. He can't (couldn't) have done it on his own.
7. He must be working now.
8. It must have been about ten when we arrived.

Ejercicio 14 · Lee y contesta

1. False ✗ — The tea was still warm, so he couldn't have left more than ten minutes earlier.
2. False ✗ — She says he might have gone.
3. False ✗ — His wallet is on the sofa.
4. Because his coat and umbrella were gone (and it was raining).
5. Because his wallet is on the sofa.
6. On his way to the station (maybe still in a taxi).
7. He must be on his way to the station. / He could still be in a taxi.
8. He might (may / could) have gone to the shop.

Ejercicio 15 · Ahora escribe tú

1. Ej.: He might be driving. He could be at the cinema. He may have lost his phone.
2. Ej.: My brother's trainers are wet. He must have been running in the rain.
3. Ej.: That footballer can't have earned 100 million in one year!
4. Ej.: Someone must have opened it. My sister might have forgotten to close it. It can't have been the wind.